ENG-0016: System Postmortem for identity-service

Impact

The identity-service system, part of Project Juniper, experienced two recent incidents of human error, both classified as Sev4 severity. Each incident required approximately 58.5 hours to resolve. Given the system's high criticality, these disruptions posed potential risks to operational integrity and data security, emphasizing the need for targeted improvements in error prevention and response procedures.

Timeline

- **Incident INC-030** was reported by E-164, with the root cause identified as human error. The incident was resolved after 58.5 hours.
- **Incident INC-046** was reported by E-163, also attributed to human error, and similarly resolved within 58.5 hours.

Both incidents occurred within a close timeframe, highlighting ongoing challenges in operational oversight for the identity-service system.

Root Cause

Analysis indicates that both incidents stemmed from human error. The recurring nature of these errors suggests a need for enhanced training, process controls, or automation to mitigate similar risks in the future.

Action Items

- Review and reinforce operational procedures for the identity-service system.
- Implement additional training modules for personnel involved in system management.
- Consider automation solutions to reduce manual intervention prone to human error.
- Monitor incident trends closely and conduct regular audits to identify potential vulnerabilities.
- Engage Mark Perez, on-call employee, to assist in developing error mitigation strategies, leveraging his familiarity with the system and operational context.

This postmortem underscores the importance of proactive risk management for the identity-service system within Project Juniper, which is owned by department D-06 and led by Aimee Montoya. Continued focus on error reduction will be critical to maintaining system availability and security.